

YILAN ANNIE GAO

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PMP · CSM · M.Ed. · M.P.I. · Bilingual English & Mandarin

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

- **12 years** of strategy and operations experience, translating complex, ambiguous challenges into structured execution — spanning creator ecosystem management, compliance operations, support escalation workflows, and data-driven program design across US and China markets.
- **Cross-functional leader** with a proven track record of driving alignment and shaping decisions across Engineering, Policy, Legal, Finance, and Business teams without formal authority; comfortable operating from executive strategy sessions to individual escalation resolution.
- **Deep passion for AI and technology**, with hands-on application of AI tools to enhance operational efficiency, and genuine enthusiasm for defining what next-generation support operations can look like in a world transformed by AI.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Program Manager, Developer Relations *Feb 2023 – Present*

Roblox Corporation | San Mateo, CA

Strategy, Compliance & Escalation Operations (2025–Present)

- **Reactive escalation ownership at scale:** serve as primary cross-functional POC for compliance and support issues affecting Roblox's top creator accounts — handling account moderation disputes, payment withdrawal blockers, and policy enforcement conflicts through direct creator engagement and internal coordination with Safety, Policy, Legal, and Finance.
- **Built Roblox's first false-moderation protection system from scratch**, defining escalation workflows, enforcement playbooks, and cross-functional communication protocols across Safety, Policy, and Legal — directly reducing wrongful content takedowns and their impact on platform engagement.
- **GTM strategy and phased rollout** of an IP protection product for the platform's top developer teams, managing continuous feedback loops and change management despite low initial prioritization.
- **Change management for policy launches:** own creator communications during shifting regulatory and safety policy cycles, translating complex compliance requirements into clear, actionable guidance; represent developer impact in VP and C-level meetings.
- **Resolved 600+ IP-related support tickets in Q1** with insights informing resource planning and process improvements; manage 3 direct reports and mentor interns.

LiveOps — Event Production & Project Management (2024)

- **Produced and project-managed 5 platform-wide events**, each reaching 10M+ players; oversaw full lifecycle from planning through live execution, managing all external vendors and contractors to ensure on-time, on-spec delivery.
- **Synthesized real-time and post-event analytics** into executive reports, translating data insights into actionable recommendations that shaped strategy for subsequent events.

International Expansion & Creator Support (2023)

- **Supported UGC developer communities** across China, Japan, and Latin America with tailored onboarding, partner communications, and localized engagement strategies; represented Roblox at international developer conferences in Mexico.
- **Co-designed a structured developer feedback system** with the PMM team, embedding DevRel into the global product development cycle to ensure international developer insights shaped product decisions upstream.

Senior Program Manager, Developer Relations *Mar 2021 – Feb 2023*

Roblox China | Shenzhen, China

- **Strategy and operations partner** to the VP of DevRel China with regular presentations to the President; orchestrated cross-functional communications aligning China market priorities with global product and business strategies.
- **Built China's data reporting infrastructure from zero:** defined data strategy alongside VP leadership, constructed the foundational reporting framework (spreadsheets, formulas, data structures), then negotiated

with HQ Finance and Operations to establish a data pipeline — enabling weekly and monthly data-driven decision support for the entire development team.

- **Defined GTM strategy for platform launch** and built executive reporting frameworks to track post-launch performance; designed and delivered high-stakes executive narratives that influenced Global HQ's investment decisions and resource allocation for China.
- **Structured ambiguous local developer and compliance needs** into prioritized recommendations for global engineering teams, ensuring China market requirements were represented in cross-functional planning cycles.
- **Designed and executed Roblox China's first-ever Game Jam**, partnering with 3 universities and achieving 10+ media placements — directly incubating several of Roblox China's current top developers.

Partnership Programs Lead *Apr 2019 – Apr 2021*

California State University, San Bernardino | San Bernardino, CA

- **Managed a portfolio of institutional partnerships**, achieving 60% recruitment growth in year one and 100% program renewal rate through proactive relationship management.
- **Designed and delivered 4 recurring end-to-end programs** totaling 130+ instructional hours; managed budgets exceeding \$4M USD.

China Programs Coordinator *Jul 2014 – Mar 2019*

Virginia Commonwealth University | Richmond, VA

- **Led international recruitment strategy**, achieving 300% enrollment growth; developed and managed 5 new signature international education programs across 10+ campus departments and 20+ partner institutions.

CERTIFICATIONS & SKILLS

AI Tools: ChatGPT/Codex · Gemini · Claude · Actively applying AI tools to enhance operational efficiency, automate workflows, and accelerate data analysis

Strategy & Operations: Go-to-Market (GTM) Strategy · Support Operations · Escalation Management · Business Planning · Cross-functional Leadership · Process Optimization · Stakeholder Management · Executive Communication

Methodologies: Agile · Scrum · Kanban · Waterfall · Action Learning

Technical Skills: Excel · Google Suite · Jira · Confluence · Data Visualization

Certifications: Project Management Professional (PMP), PMI · Certified Scrum Master (CSM) · Business Analytics, Udacity · Data Visualization, Udacity · UX/UI Design, Udacity

Languages: English · Chinese

EDUCATION

Master of Product Innovation*Dec 2018*

Virginia Commonwealth University | Richmond, VA

Master of Education — Adult Learning & Human Resource Development*May 2014*

Virginia Commonwealth University | Richmond, VA

Bachelor of Arts — English & International Relations*Jul 2012*

Sichuan International Studies University | Chongqing, China